

Common Job Interview Mistakes and What to Do Instead

By Luke Tobin



1. Over-Rehearsed Answers Can **Sound Robotic**

Why it's a mistake:

Over-preparing makes your responses **sound rehearsed and inauthentic**.

What to do instead:

Be conversational - prepare key points, but **adapt naturally** during the interview.

2. Focusing Only on Your Achievements **Can Seem Self-Centered**

Why it's a mistake:

Talking only about your success may signal a **lack of team spirit.**

What to do instead:

Highlight how your contributions benefited the team and company, not just yourself. **Show you are a team player** and think of others.

3. Not Asking Questions Makes You Seem Uninterested

Why it's a mistake:

Failing to ask questions shows a **lack of curiosity** about the role or company.

What to do instead:

Ask thoughtful questions about company culture, growth opportunities, and team dynamics.

4. Talking About Weaknesses **Without a Plan for Improvement**

Why it's a mistake:

Admitting to weaknesses without a plan can signal a **lack of self-awareness** or growth mindset.

What to do instead:

Frame weaknesses as areas you're actively working on and share how you're **dedicated to improving**.

5. Failing to Follow Up **Makes You Forgettable**

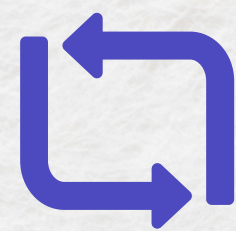
Why it's a mistake:

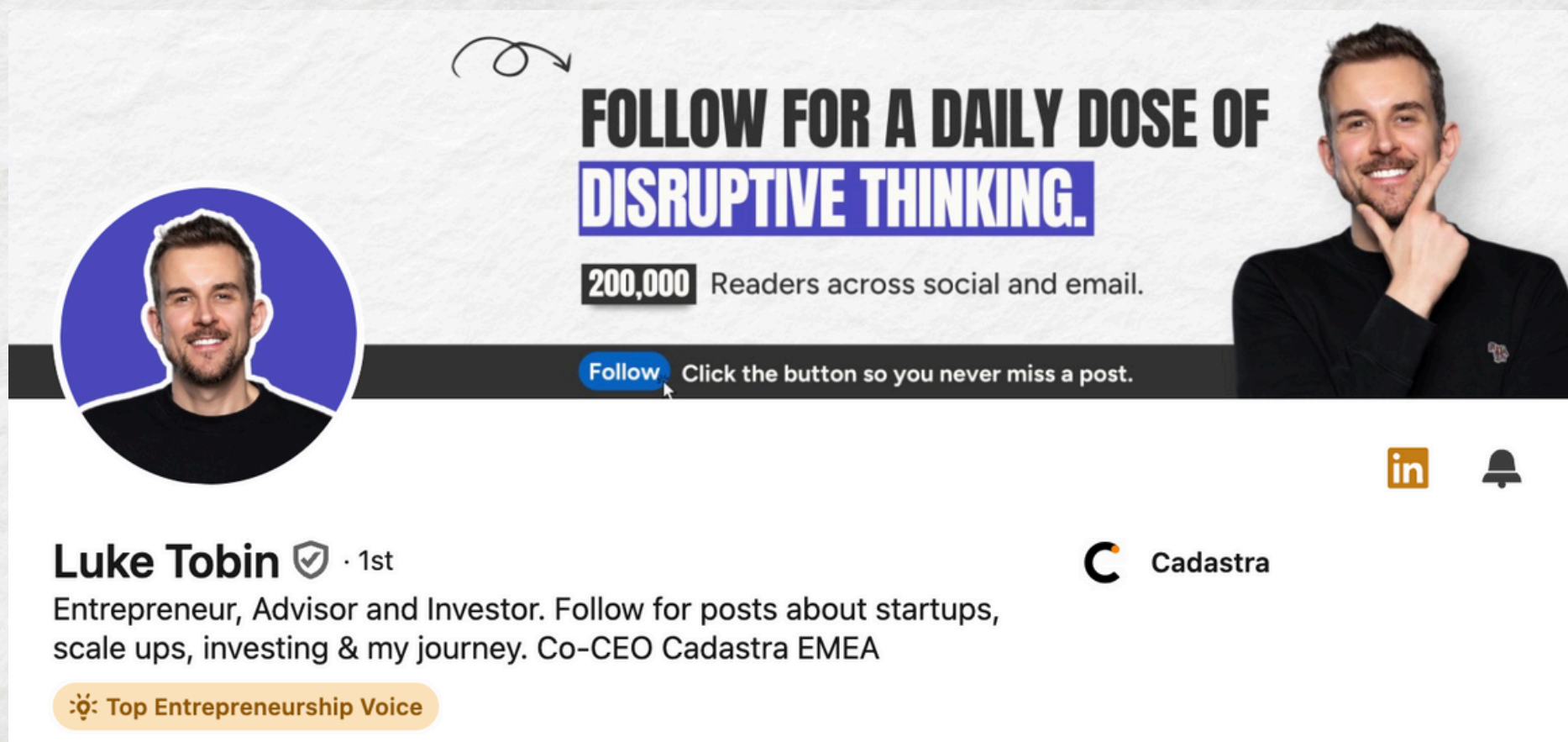
Not sending a follow-up email shows a **lack of interest or professionalism.**

What to do instead:

Send a personalised follow-up note thanking the interviewer and **reiterating your enthusiasm** for the role.

Found it valuable?

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A screenshot of a LinkedIn profile for Luke Tobin. The profile header features a circular profile picture of Luke Tobin on the left and a banner image on the right. The banner text reads "FOLLOW FOR A DAILY DOSE OF DISRUPTIVE THINKING." with "DISRUPTIVE THINKING." in a blue box. Below the banner, it says "200,000 Readers across social and email." and a "Follow" button with the text "Click the button so you never miss a post." To the right of the banner is a photo of Luke Tobin. Below the profile picture, the name "Luke Tobin" is followed by a verified badge and "· 1st". The bio reads: "Entrepreneur, Advisor and Investor. Follow for posts about startups, scale ups, investing & my journey. Co-CEO Cadastra EMEA". Below the bio is a badge that says "Top Entrepreneurship Voice". To the right of the bio is the "Cadastra" logo.



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